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ADDING LINKS

- **The a element**
- **External links with absolute URLs**
- **Links with relative pathnames**
- **Linking within a page (fragments)**
- **Targeting browser windows**
- **Mail links**

Adding Links

`<a> </a>`

`<a href="URL">Link text or image</a>`

The `href` attribute provides the location (URL) of the resource.

You can link to any resource:

- HTML documents

- Images

- Movies

- PDFs

- More!

WRITING LINKS

```
<a href="http://www.imdb.com">IMDB</a>
```

WRITING LINKS

THE PAGE THE **LINK**
TAKES YOU TO



```
<a href="http://www.imdb.com">IMDB</a>
```

WRITING LINKS

THE PAGE THE **LINK**
TAKES YOU TO

```
graph TD; A["<a href='http://www.imdb.com'>IMDB</a>"] --- B["THE PAGE THE LINK TAKES YOU TO"]; A --- C["THE TEXT THE USER CLICKS ON"]
```

`<a href="http://www.imdb.com">IMDB</a>`

THE **TEXT** THE USER
CLICKS ON

LINKING TO OTHER SITES

HTML

```
<a href="http://www.empireonline.com">  
Empire</a>
```


Empire

LINKING TO OTHER PAGES ON THE SAME SITE

HTML

```
<a href="index.html">Home</a>
```

```
<a href="about.html">About</a>
```

```
<a href="movies.html">Movies</a>
```

```
<a href="contact.html">Contact</a>
```

- Home
- About
- Movies
- Contact

href Attributes

RESULT

- **Absolute URLs** begin with the protocol (ex: `http://`).
- **Relative URLs** provide the path to a file on the same server as the document containing the link
(ex: `/directory/document.html`).
- Long URLs can make the markup look complicated, but the structure is the same:

Opening anchor tag

```
<a href="https://www.amazon.com/Bequet-Gourmet-Caramel-24oz-Celtic/dp/B00GZEU10Y/ref=sr_1_1_a_it?ie=UTF8&qid=1467055107&sr=8-1&keywords=bequet">Bequet Caramels</a>
```

URL

Linked text

Closing anchor tag

A diagram illustrating the structure of an HTML anchor tag. The code snippet is: `<a href="https://www.amazon.com/Bequet-Gourmet-Caramel-24oz-Celtic/dp/B00GZEU10Y/ref=sr_1_1_a_it?ie=UTF8&qid=1467055107&sr=8-1&keywords=bequet">Bequet Caramels</a>`. The entire code is highlighted in green. A vertical line points from the label "Opening anchor tag" to the opening tag `<a href="`. Another vertical line points from the label "URL" to the long URL string within the quotes. A bracket underneath the text "Bequet Caramels" points to the label "Linked text". A vertical line points from the label "Closing anchor tag" to the closing tag `</a>`.

External Links

- **External links** go to pages that are **not** on your server.
- An absolute URL is required, including “**http://**”

```
<li><a href="http://www.foodnetwork.com">The Food  
Network</a></li>
```

Opening anchor tag

```
<a href="https://www.amazon.com/Bequet-Gourmet-Caramel-24oz  
-Celtic/dp/B00GZEU10Y/ref=sr_1_1_a_it?ie=UTF8&qid=1467055107&s  
r=8-1&keywords=bequet">Bequet Caramels</a>
```

URL

Linked text

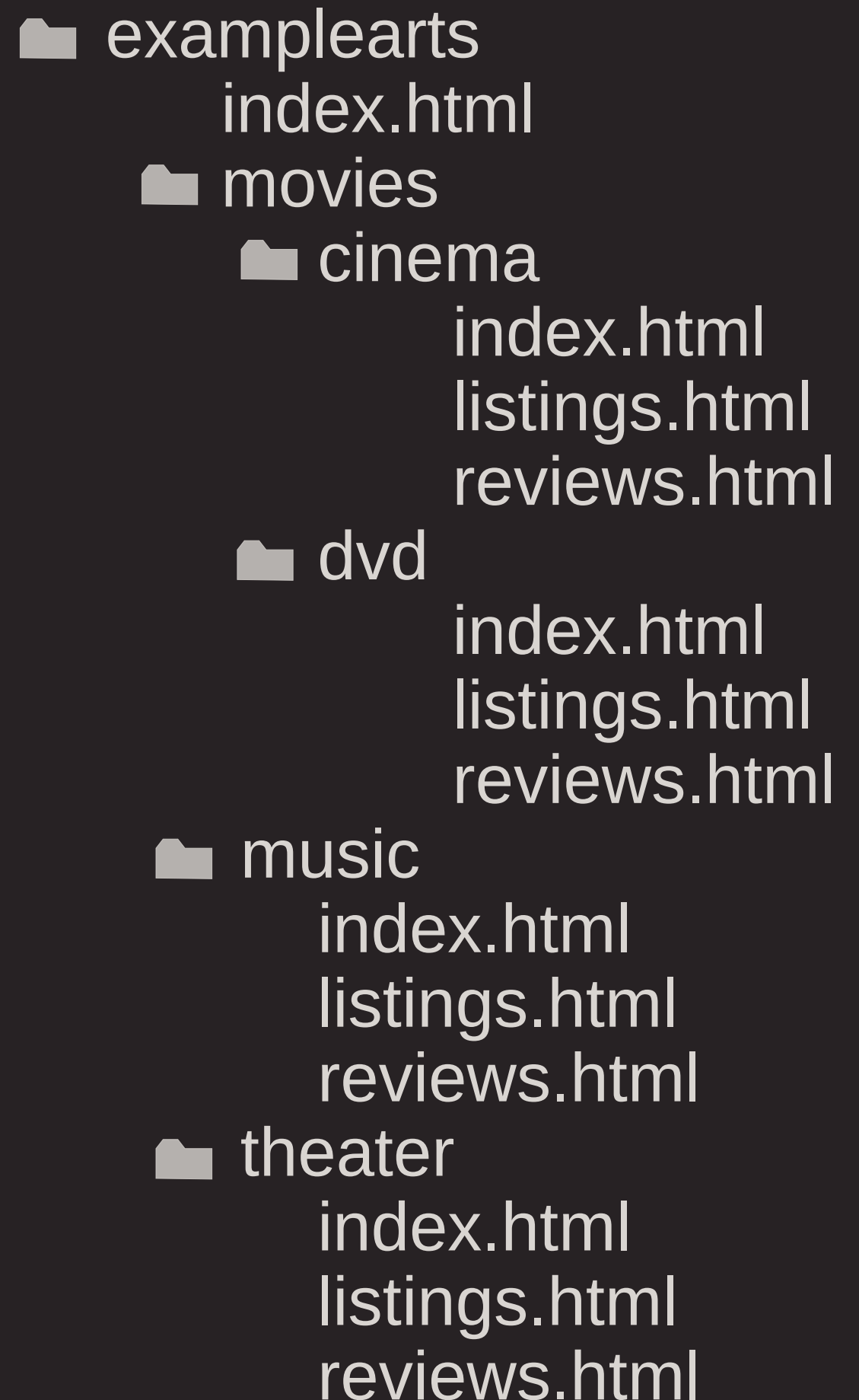
Closing anchor tag

Linking on Your Own Site

RESULT

- When no protocol is provided, the browser looks on the current server for the resource.
- A **relative pathname** describes how to get to the resource starting from the current document.
- Pathnames follow UNIX syntax conventions.

DIRECTORY STRUCTURE



DIRECTORY STRUCTURE

ROOT FOLDER

 examplearts

index.html

 movies

 cinema

index.html

listings.html

reviews.html

 dvd

index.html

listings.html

reviews.html

 music

index.html

listings.html

reviews.html

 theater

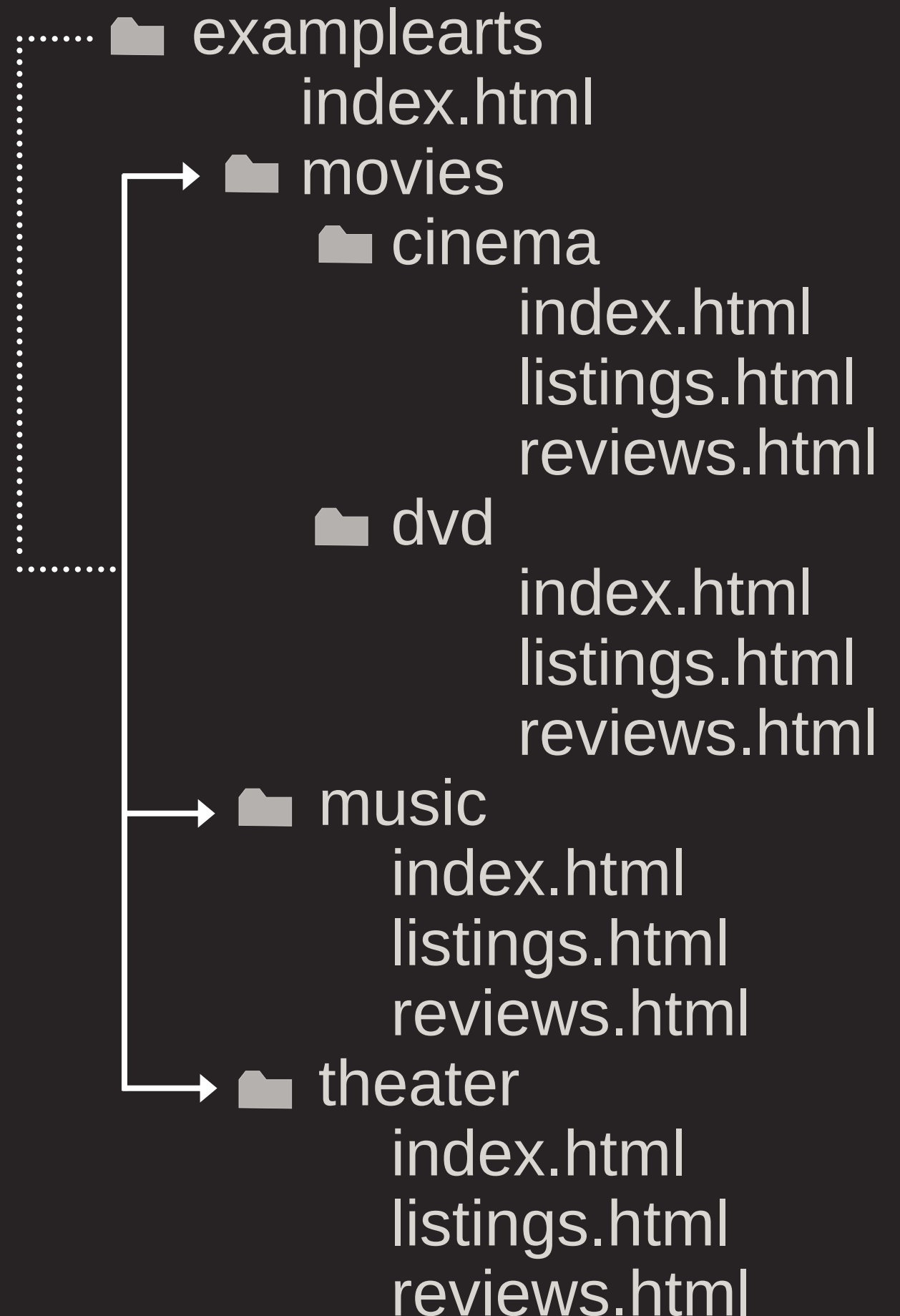
index.html

listings.html

reviews.html

DIRECTORY STRUCTURE

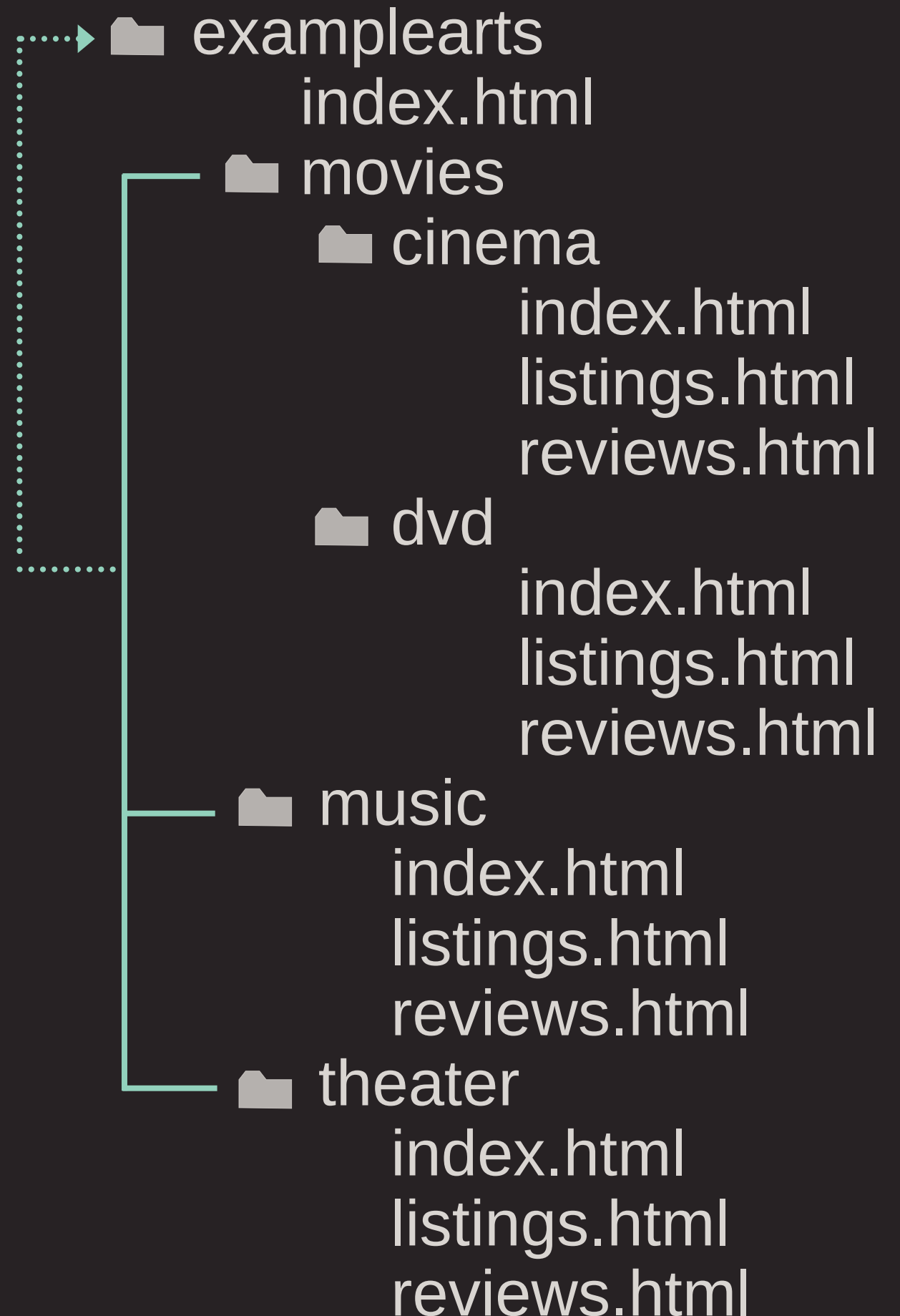
CHILD



DIRECTORY STRUCTURE

CHILD

PARENT

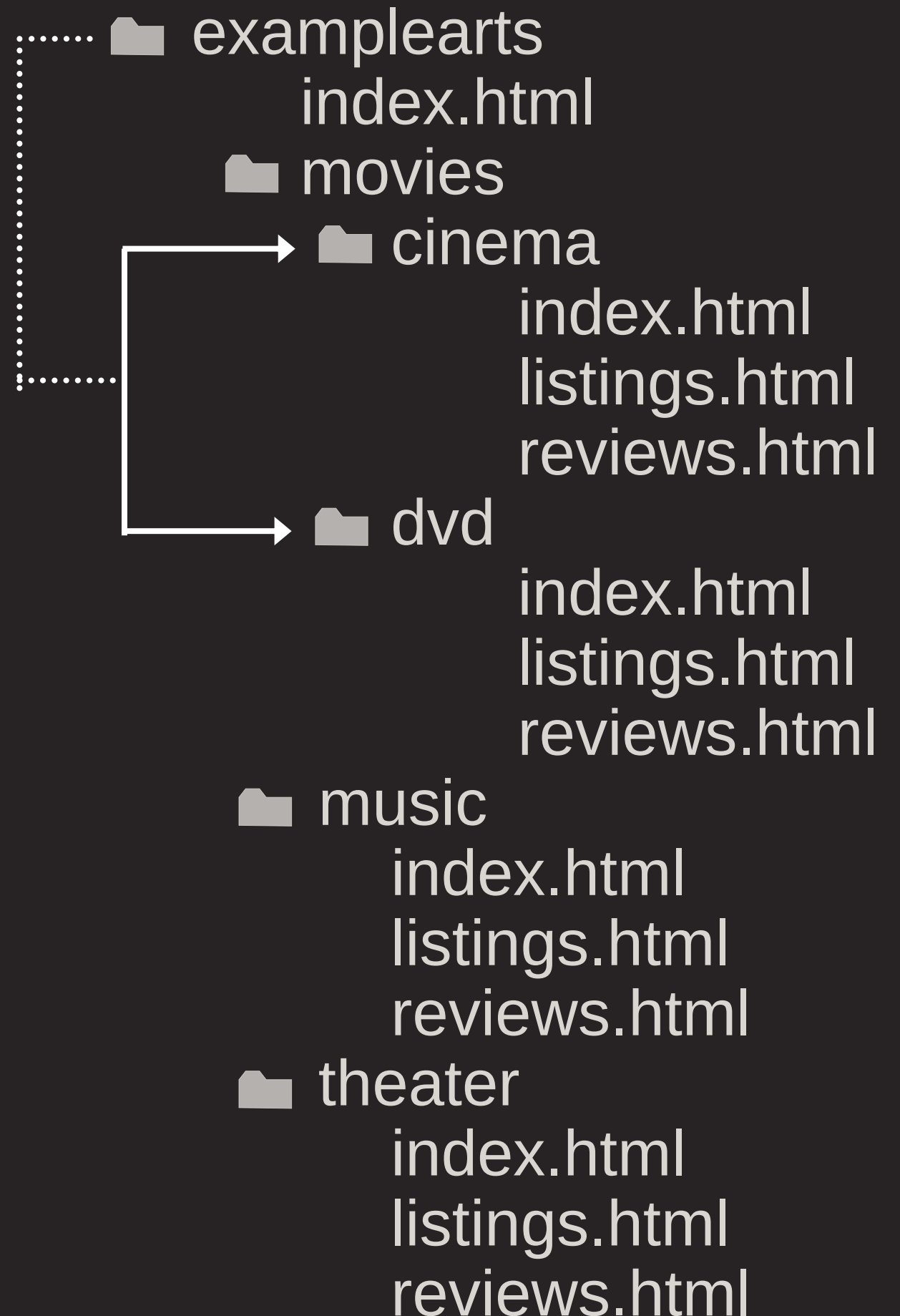


DIRECTORY STRUCTURE

CHILD

PARENT

GRANDCHILD



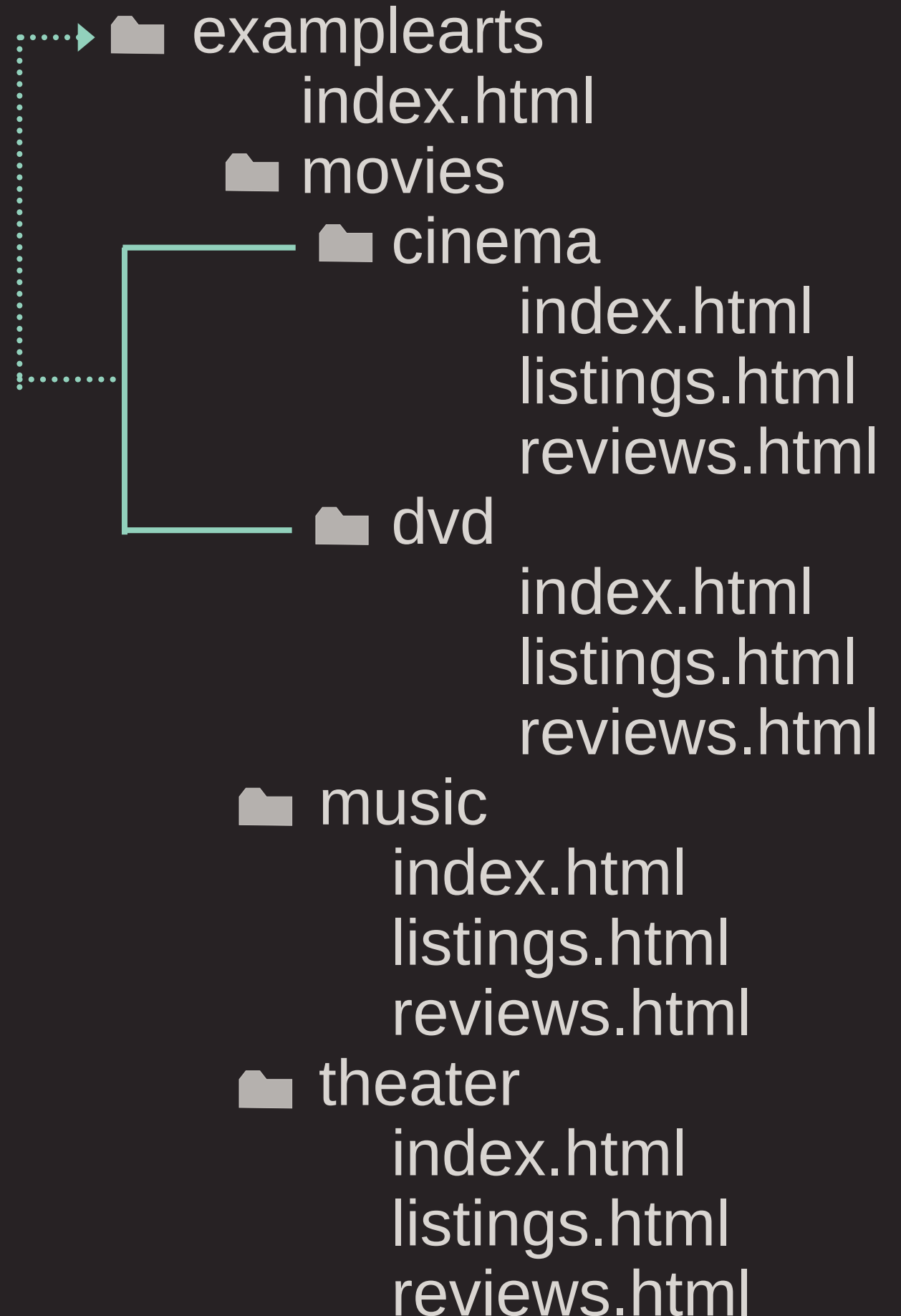
DIRECTORY STRUCTURE

CHILD

PARENT

GRANDCHILD

GRANDPARENT



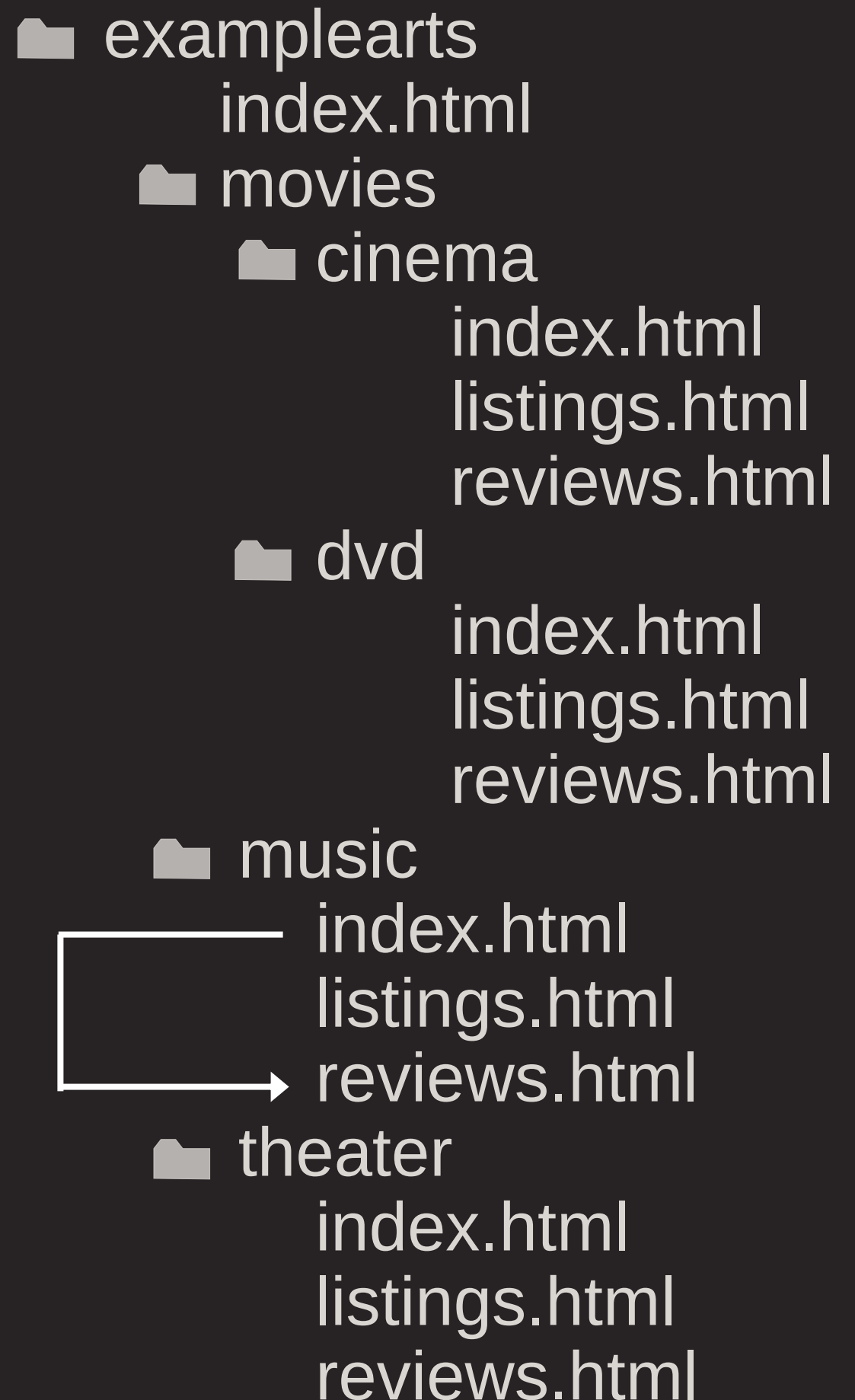
RELATIVE URLS

```
└─ examplearts
   └─ index.html
      └─ movies
         └─ cinema
            └─ index.html
               listings.html
               reviews.html
            └─ dvd
               └─ index.html
                  listings.html
                  reviews.html
         └─ music
            └─ index.html
               listings.html
               reviews.html
         └─ theater
            └─ index.html
               listings.html
               reviews.html
```

RELATIVE URLS

SAME

reviews.html



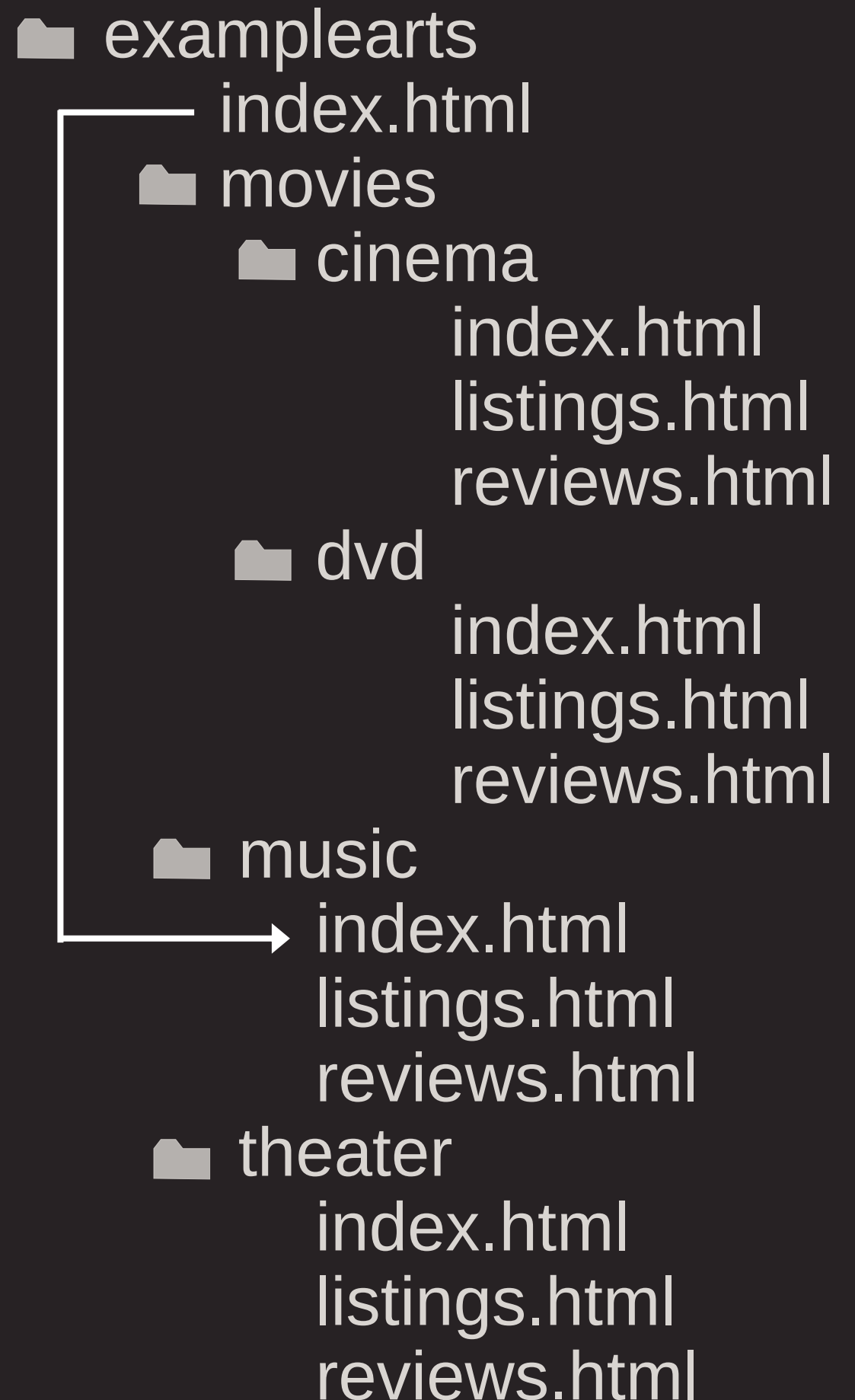
RELATIVE URLS

SAME

`reviews.html`

CHILD

`music/index.html`



RELATIVE URLS

SAME

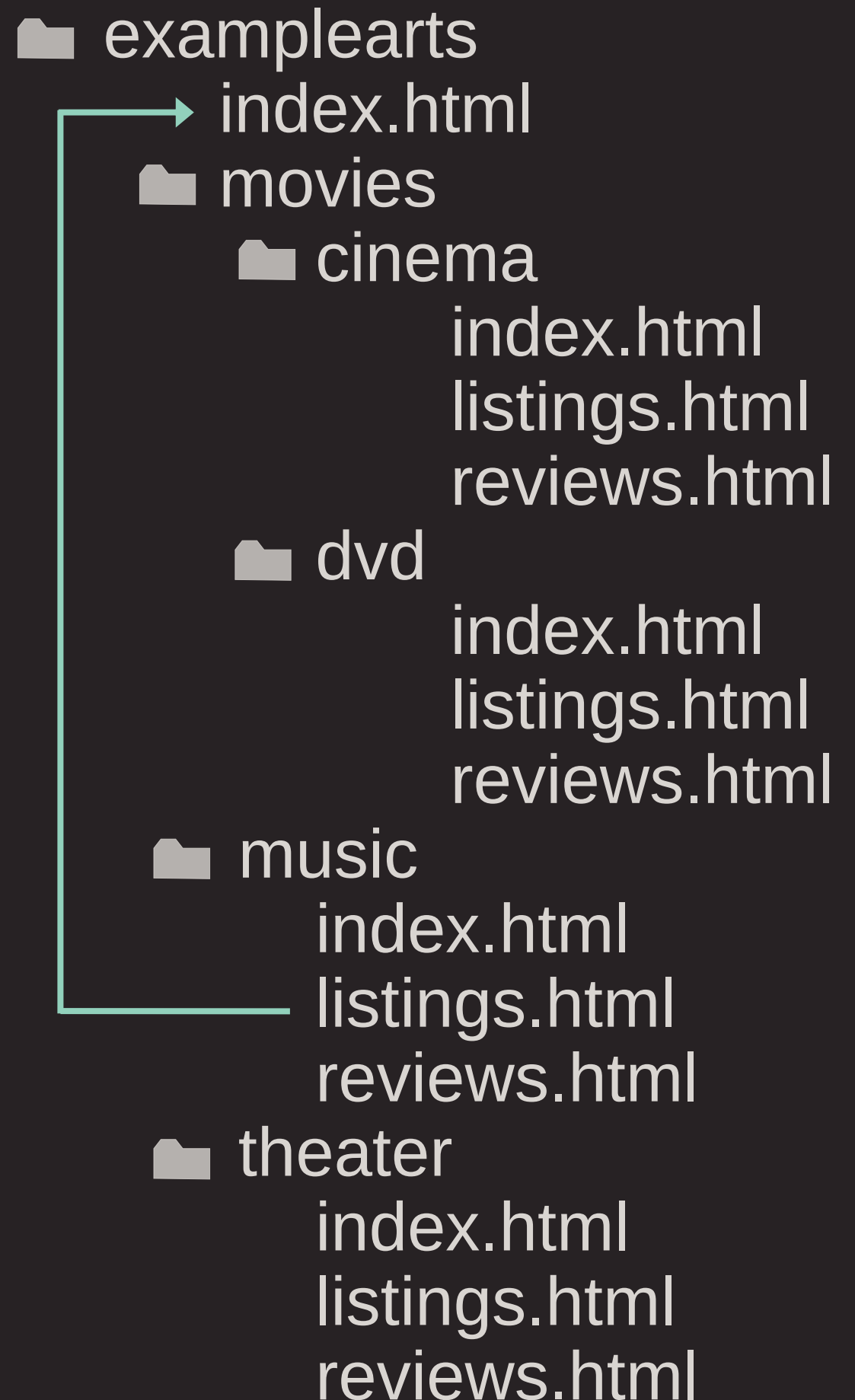
`reviews.html`

CHILD

`music/index.html`

PARENT

`../index.html`



RELATIVE URLS

SAME

`reviews.html`

CHILD

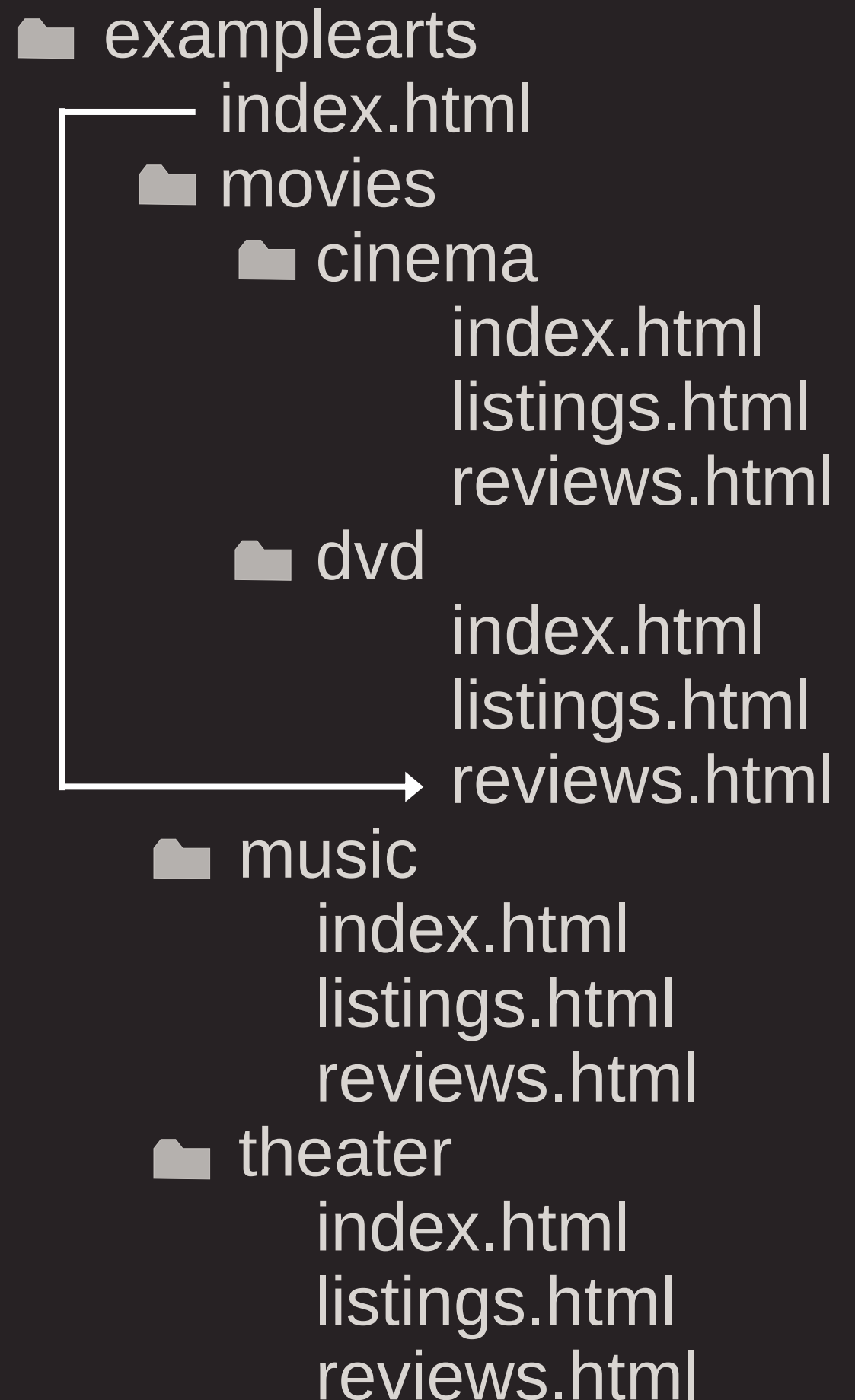
`music/index.html`

PARENT

`../index.html`

GRANDCHILD

`movies/dvd/index.html`



RELATIVE URLS

SAME

`reviews.html`

CHILD

`music/index.html`

PARENT

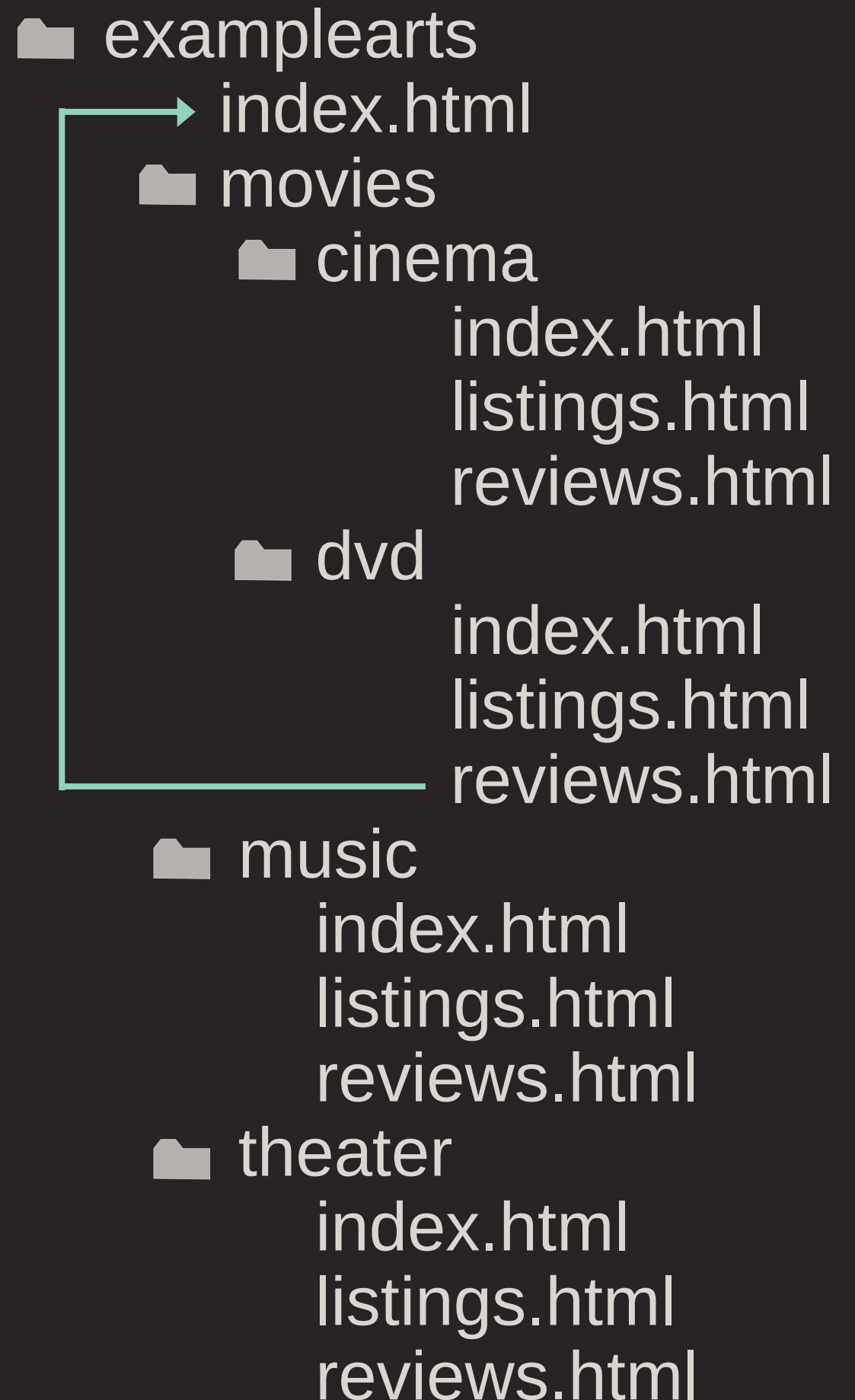
`../index.html`

GRANDCHILD

`movies/dvd/index.html`

GRANDPARENT

`../../index.html`



OPENING LINKS IN A NEW WINDOW

HTML

```
<a href="http://www.imdb.com"  
  target="_blank">IMDB</a> (opens in a  
  new window)
```

OPENING LINKS IN A NEW WINDOW

HTML

```
<a href="http://www.imdb.com"  
  target="_blank">IMDB</a> (opens in a  
  new window)
```

[Internet Movie Database](#) (opens in new window)

SUMMARY

Links are created using the
<a> element.

SUMMARY

The `<a>` element uses the `href` attribute to indicate the page you are linking to.

SUMMARY

If you are linking to a page within your own site, it is best to use relative links rather than qualified URLs.

SUMMARY

You can create links to open email programs with an email address in the "to" field.

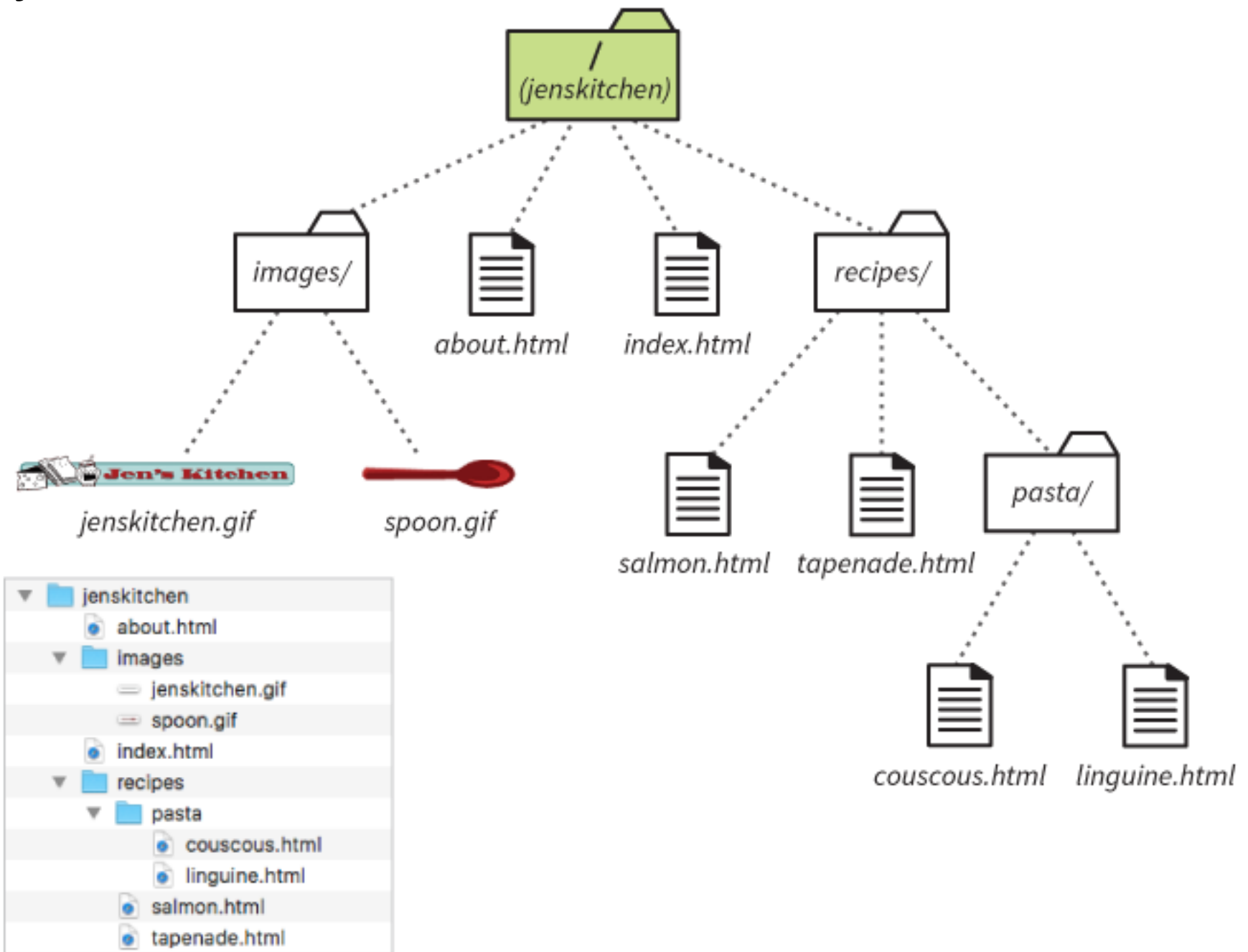
SUMMARY

You can use the `id` attribute to target elements within a page that can be linked to.

Example Server Directory Structure

The following relative pathname discussions are based on this site structure.

The root directory is called *jenskitchen*.



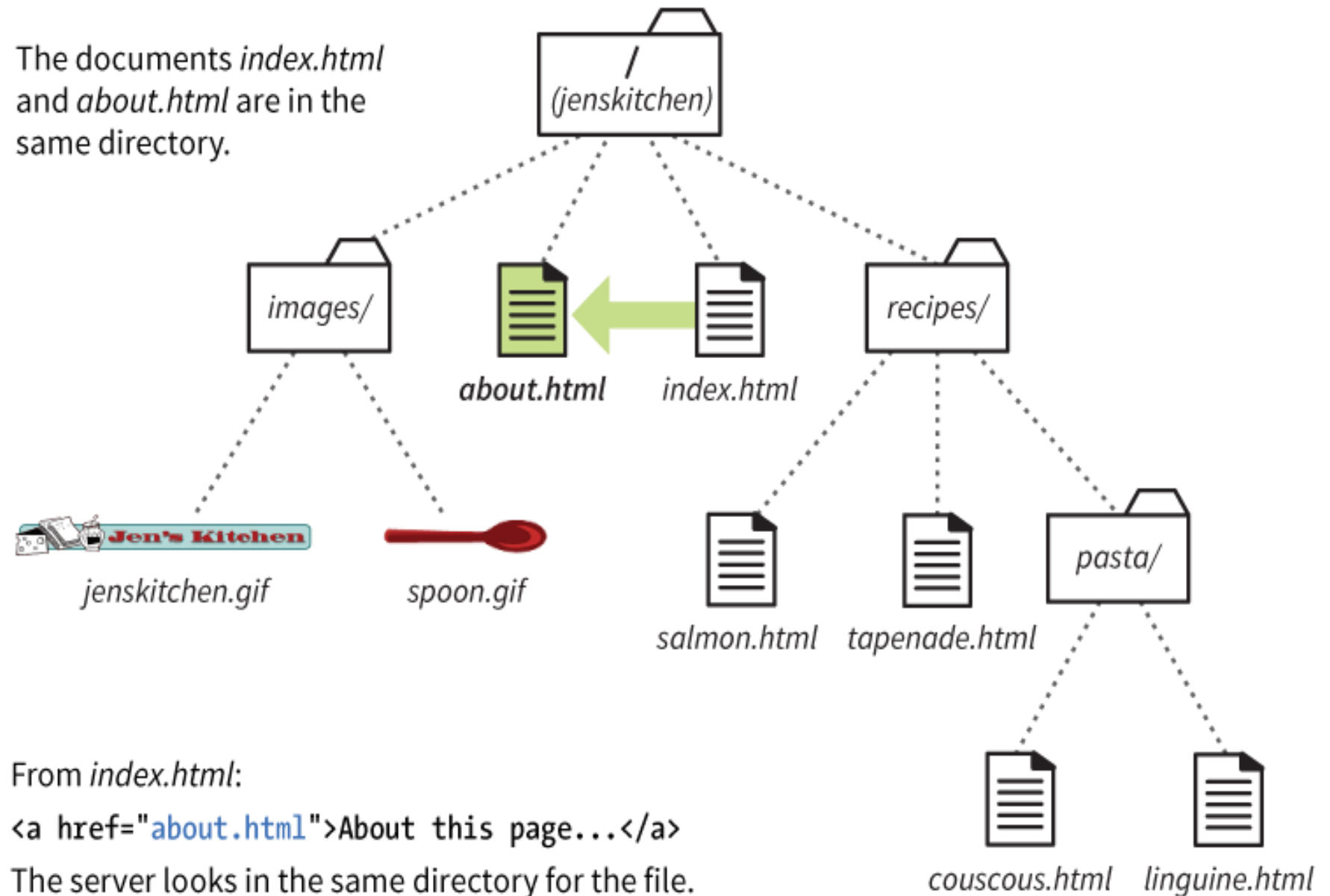
How it looks in the
MacOS Finder

Linking in the Same Directory

When the linked document is in the same directory as the current document, just provide its filename:

`href="about.html"`

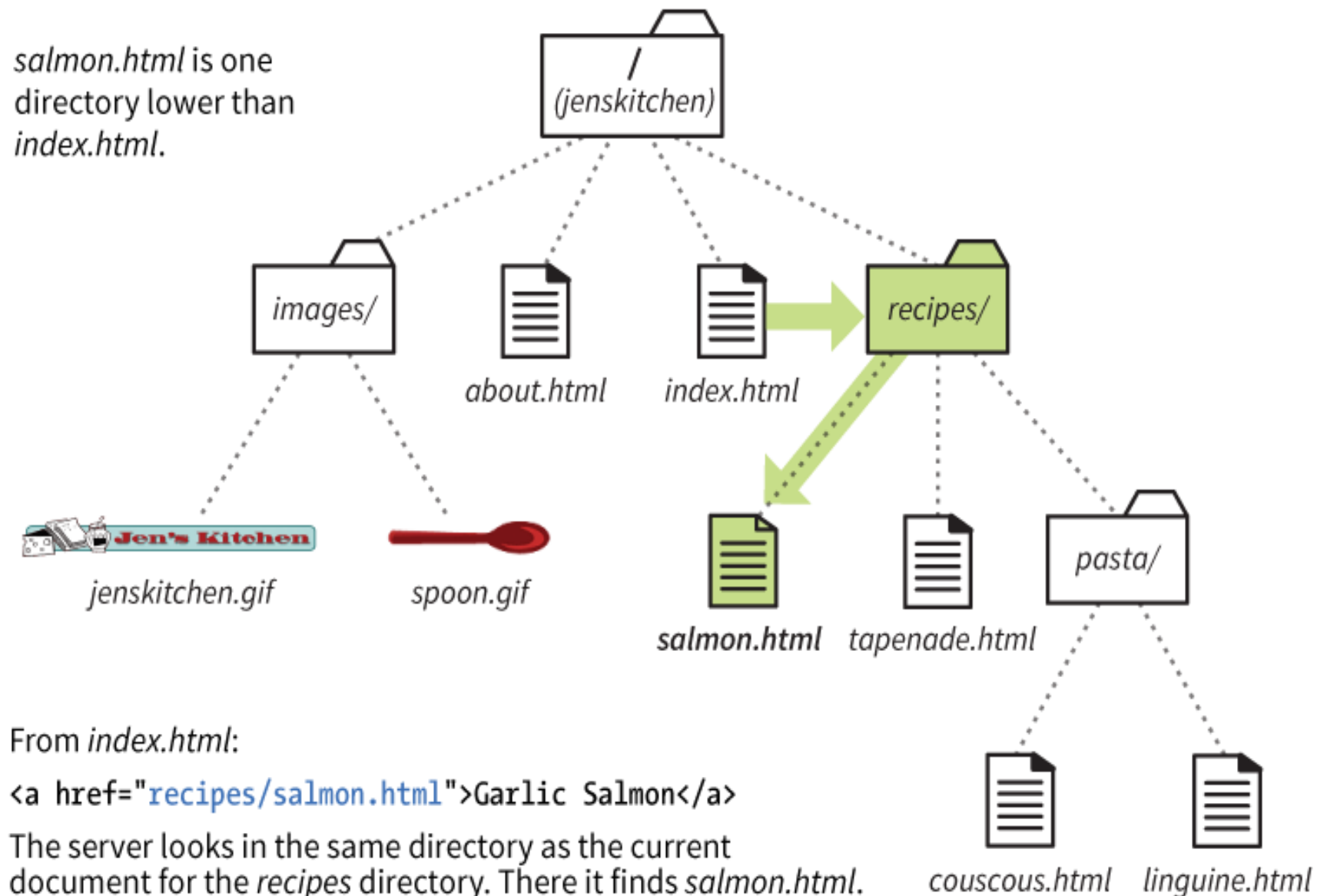
The documents *index.html* and *about.html* are in the same directory.



Linking into a Lower Directory

If the linked file is in a directory, include the directory name in the path.

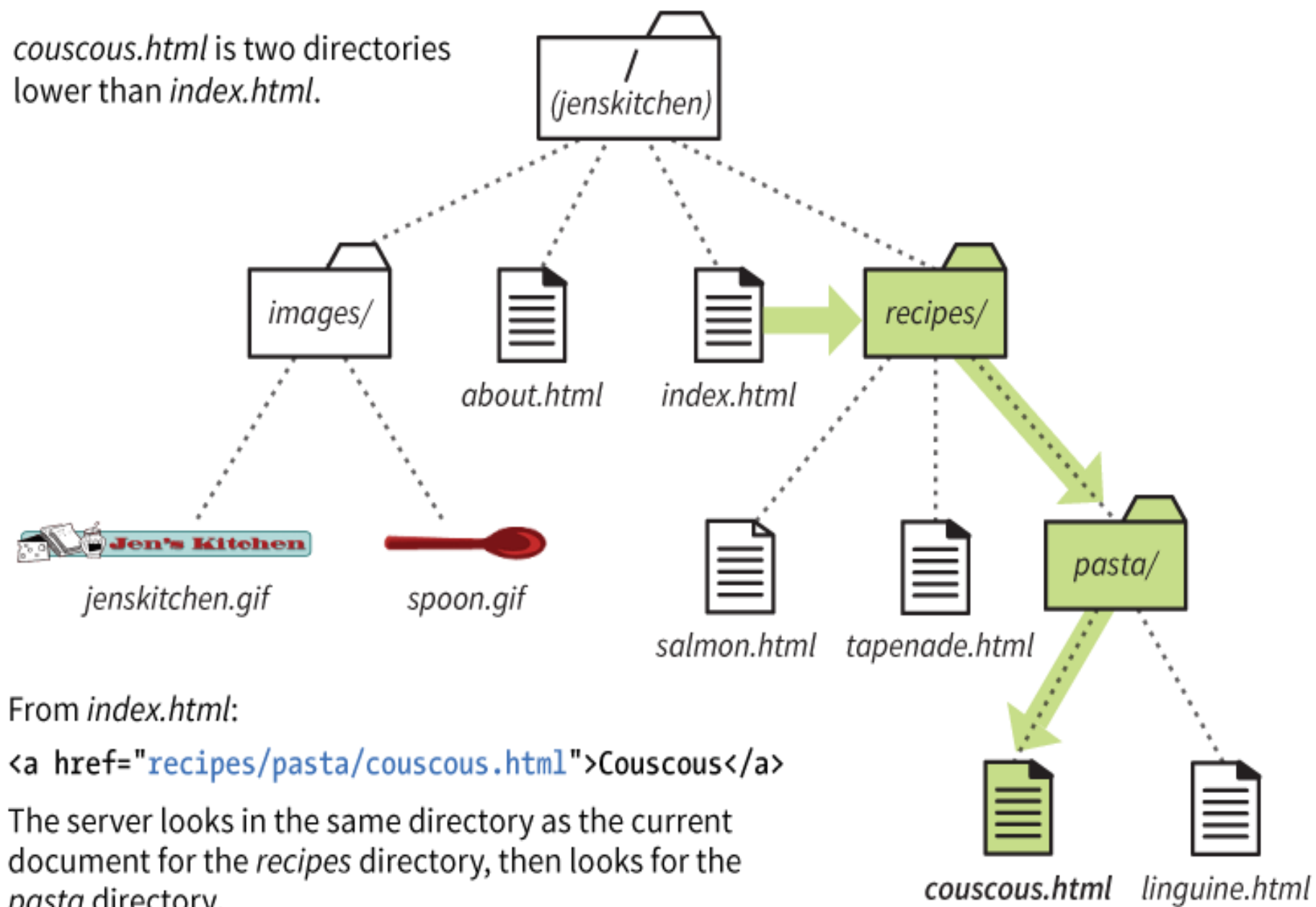
`href="recipes/salmon.html"`



Linking into Two Directory

Include each subdirectory name in the path to the linked document:

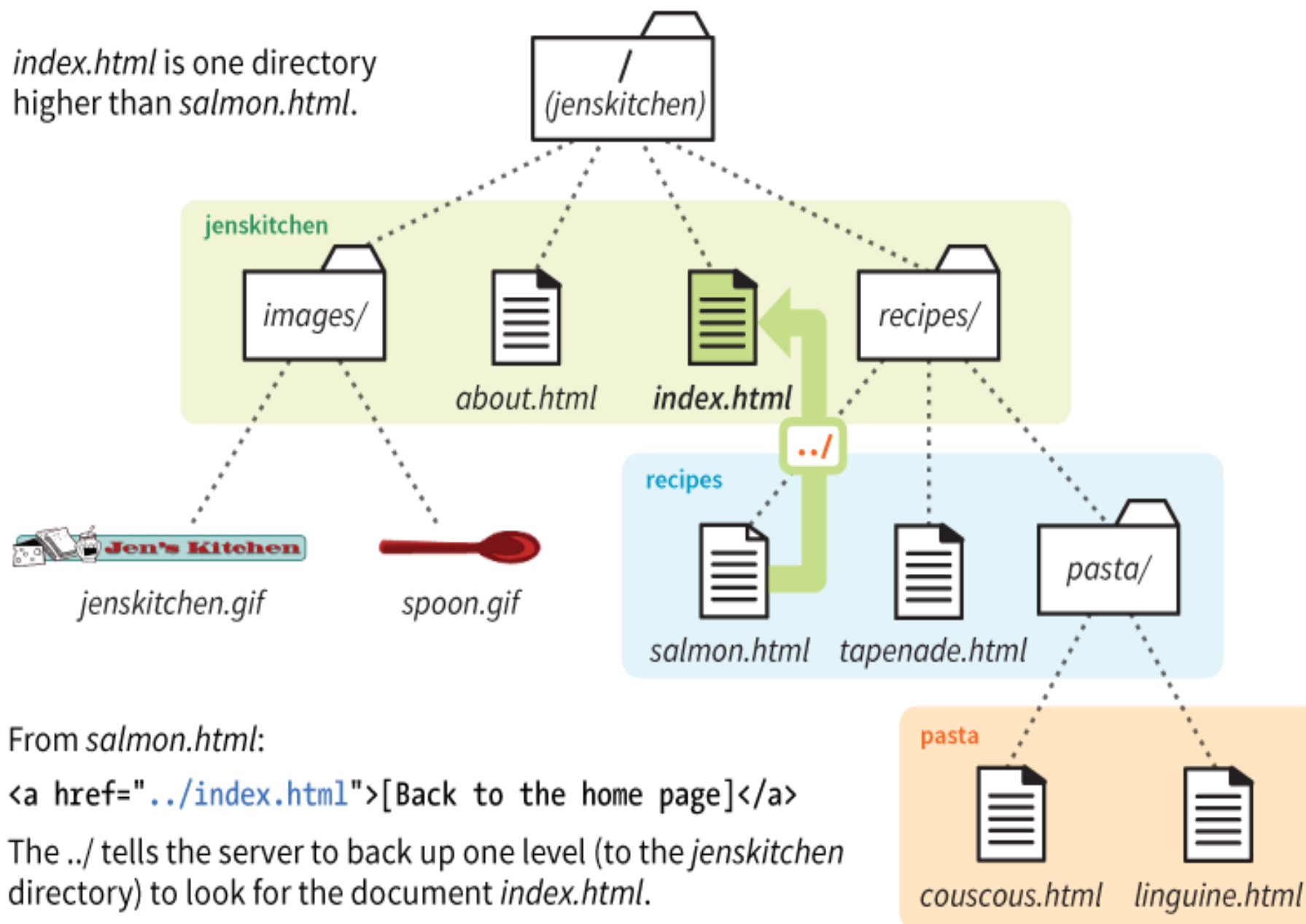
`href="recipes/pasta/couscous.html"`



Linking to a Higher Directory

To back up a level, the `../` stands in for the name of the higher directory:

```
href=" ../index.html "
```



Linking Up Two Directory Levels

Include a `../` for each level you need to back up to:

`href="../../../index.html"`

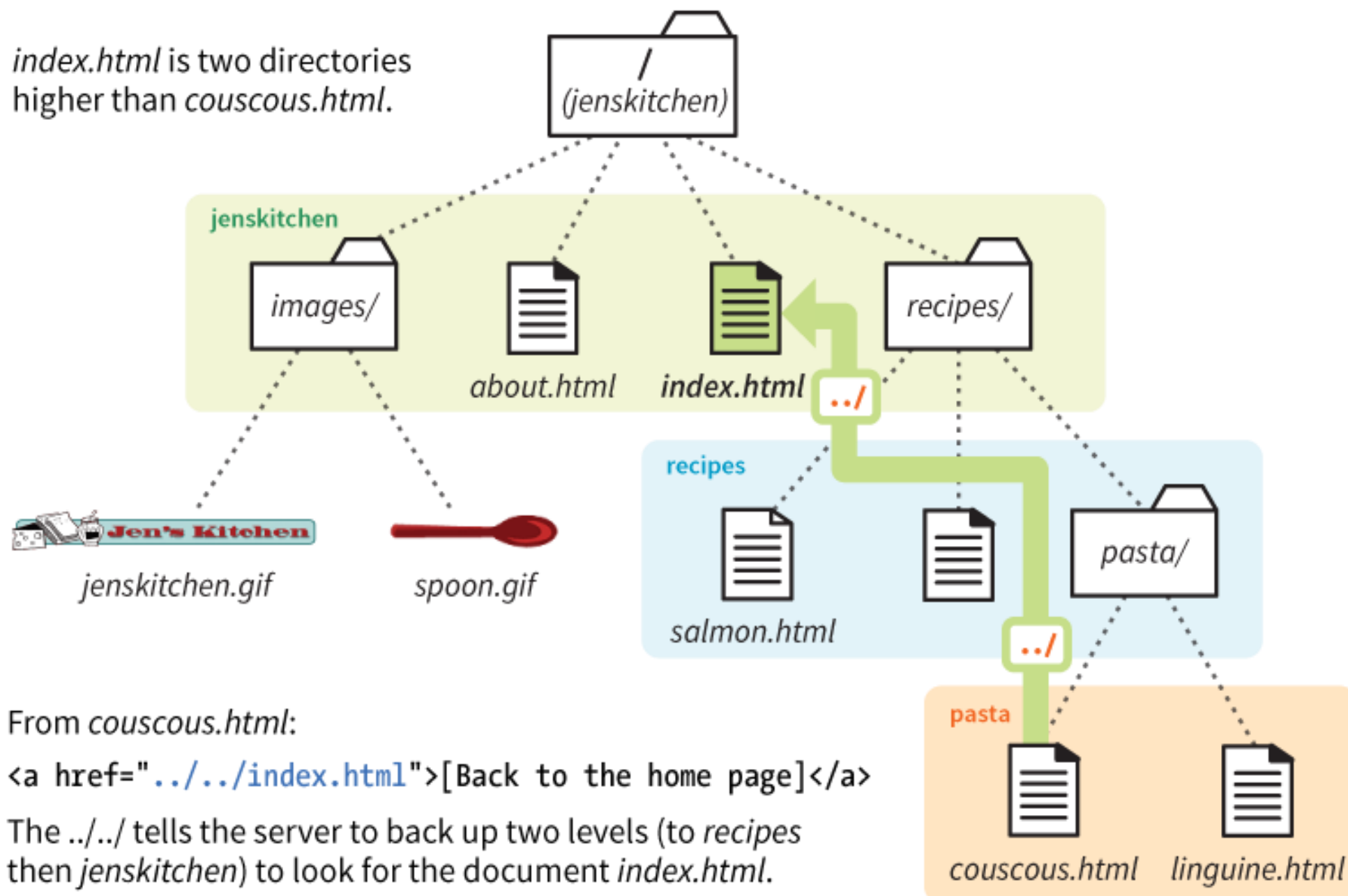


Image src Pathnames

Relative pathnames are also commonly used to point to image files with the **src** attribute:

```

```